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□□□□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□ □ **Of the clever kAlIdAsa by: Kedar
Naphade,** **ksn2@lehigh.edu**

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once proclaimed, "If any poet reads a new poem in my court, I
shall give him One Lakh Rupees". Having heard this indeed
many poets thronged the palace in order to read their poetry.)
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(However, in the court there were several scholars who could re-recite a poem completely just after having listened to it once. Then there were others who could re-recite it after they had heard it twice, and yet others who could do it after the third reading.) □□□ □□□ □□□□□ □□□□□ □□□□□□□□,

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□ (So whenever any poet came and read his new poem, some scholars sad, this is not really new. see, we also know it. Then they recited the whole poem. then those who could remember things after they had heard it twice said the same thinf and recited the poem. Then those who remembered things after they had heard them thrice did the same thing. Hence no poet was able to claim the lakh rupees.) □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□

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□□□□□□□□□□ □□ (kAlIdAsa didnt really like this. He took one poet to his room, and gave him the following subhAshhita -)

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□□□□□□ □□□□ □□ □□ // (O King Bhoj, let there be good! You

are the (greatest) just and true-speaker in the whole world. 99
Crores of precious stones belonging to me were taken by your
father. Give them back to me, O king all the scholars in your court
know that this is true. If they do not, then they do not know my
poem either. Then give me the lakh!)

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(The poet read this poem in the court. None of the scholars were
able to say that they knew this poetry. So the poet got one lakh
rupees. Kalidasa was indeed clever!)

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Kedar Naphade, ksn2@lehigh.edu

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poet kAlIdAsa was in King Bhoj's court. Once a foreign scholar
sent a message to King Bhoj. It said, "I shall come on such and
such date to debate and discuss with the scholars in your court".
King Bhoj th en mentioned in his court that this scholar was
going to come. □□□□□□□□ □□□□□□ □□□□□□□□
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scholar arrived, kAlIdAsa disguised himself as a palanquin
carrier and went to recieve him. The scholar did not know that he
was indeed kAlIdAsa. Carrying the pAlakhl on his shoulders,
kAlIdAsa set off with the scholar. It was winter that time and the
cold wind was hitting the body. The scholar said, "The cold hurts
very much," Clever kAlIdAs immediately retorted, "Cold does
not hurt as much as 'badhati'" □□□□□□□□□□ □□□□ □□□□□
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□□□□ □□□□□□□□□□, □□□ □ The scholar did not know
that the verb "badh" was 'Atmanep adi' (and hence had used the
wrong form bAdhati instead of the correct form bAdhate') He
thought, if even the palakhicarriers in this kingdom know the
language so well, then meeting with the scholars shall certainly
lead to my defeat. then he ordered kAlIdAsa, i really do not want
to go to this extremely cold place. we should go back home."

